

## LOSING LUSTRE

- 1 **PRICES OF ALL EXCEPT ONE CRYPTOCURRENCY FROM THE TOP 10 CRYPTOCURRENCIES IN TERMS OF M-CAP HAVE DROPPED BY MORE THAN HALF FROM THEIR ALL-TIME HIGHS**
- 2 **BITCOIN HAS GIVEN 55 PER CENT RETURNS SINCE THE START OF 2023**

| Name        | Price in \$* | All-time high (ATH) in \$ | Percentage change from ATH | YTD percentage change |
|-------------|--------------|---------------------------|----------------------------|-----------------------|
| Bitcoin     | 25,830       | 68,789.63                 | -62                        | 55                    |
| Ethereum    | 1,615        | 4,891.7                   | -67                        | 35                    |
| BNB         | 212          | 690.93                    | -69                        | -13                   |
| Solana      | 18.31        | 260.06                    | -93                        | 0.84                  |
| USD Coin    | 1            | 2.35                      | -57                        | 0                     |
| Tether USDt | 0.99         | 1.22                      | -17.76                     | 0                     |
| XRP         | 0.49         | 3.84                      | -87                        | 47                    |
| Cardano     | 0.24         | 3.1                       | -92                        | -0.39                 |
| TRON        | 0.07         | 0.3                       | -74                        | 0.43                  |
| Dogecoin    | 0.06         | 0.73                      | -92                        | -13                   |

\*AS OF SEPTEMBER 11, 2023 (12:44 PM IST); **SOURCE:**COINMARKETCAP.COM

who are supplying it [will] simply go away in a puff of smoke.”

While opinion about crypto has always been divided, crypto trading declined in India only after heavy taxes were imposed. With transaction volumes dwindling at crypto exchanges, what are the founders doing to deal with the crisis?

### THE CRYPTO CHALLENGE

For the founders of crypto exchanges in India, it is a battle for survival. And for that, they are embracing diverse strategies. These include exploring alternative revenue sources, implementing workforce reductions, and cutting down marketing expenditure. Some are seeking to di-

versify their business, while others have moved to more crypto-friendly locations. While the tax prompted some to move out of the country, there are others who had moved to crypto-friendly locations earlier.

Take, for example, Nischal Shetty, Founder and CEO of WazirX, one of the largest crypto exchanges in the country. “I moved to Dubai (in 2021) to start Shardeum (a blockchain platform), which is a Switzerland-based company. The crypto regulations are friendly in Dubai and Switzerland and it was easier to work from Dubai for us,” he says.

Shetty, whose company laid off 40 per cent of its employees in 2022 after the slowdown and shut down

**SUMIT GUPTA,**  
CEO & CO-FOUNDER,  
COINDCX



► Currently building Web 3.0, investing in Web 3.0 start-ups. Forayed into DeFi by launching Okto

**“We have used this period of slowdown as an opportunity to focus on building and simplifying Web 3.0 for the masses”**

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**NISCHAL SHETTY**  
FOUNDER & CEO, WAZIRX



► Now focussing on generating revenues from trading; new revenue streams are at an experimental stage

**“We laid off people because of a decline in business but we have enough [financial] runway to continue with our business”**